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# Transcripción de audio

IELTS Academic · Set 4

## 01 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 1: Consulta sobre alojamiento estudiantil

Officer: Good morning, Greenfield University Housing Office. How can I help you?

Student: Hi, yes. I'm a new postgraduate student and I'm looking for accommodation on campus. Could you help me?

Officer: Of course. Can I take your name and student number?

Student: Sure. My name's Paulo Ferreira - F-E-R-R-E-I-R-A - and my student number is PG 4471 dash 8.

Officer: Before we begin the formal record, I should explain how I handle a student-housing enquiry. I will check the main requirement first, then compare the practical options, and finally read the record back. That gives us a chance to correct a misunderstanding before anything is confirmed.

Student: That approach would be helpful for the student-housing enquiry. I made some notes beforehand, although I was not sure whether every detail I found still applied, so I would rather verify it during this conversation.

Officer: Thank you, Mr Ferreira. And what faculty are you in?

Student: Environmental Science.

Officer: Great. And are you looking for a single room or a shared flat?

Student: For this student-housing enquiry, I am not simply looking for the cheapest possibility. I need to understand what the standard arrangement includes and what would count as an optional extra, because changing plans later could be inconvenient.

Officer: Of course. In this student-housing enquiry, I will flag any condition that depends on availability, and you can stop me whenever two alternatives sound too similar.

Student: I'd prefer a single room, but I'm happy to share a kitchen and bathroom with others.

Officer: That would be a cluster flat then. We have two options available from 1st September. The first is Maple Court - it's a ten-minute walk from the main campus. Each room has a desk, wardrobe, and single bed. The shared kitchen is fully equipped. The monthly rent is four hundred and twenty pounds.

Student: And the second option?

Officer: A student-housing enquiry can involve names, dates and choices that differ in only one important detail. I will therefore use the full wording and repeat any number in a separate group. Please ask immediately if something conflicts with your notes.

Student: I will. For the student-housing enquiry, I would prefer to correct a small point now, especially because I may need to coordinate this with another commitment.

Officer: The second is Cedar Hall - it's actually on campus, so very convenient. Monthly rent is four hundred and seventy-five pounds. The rooms are slightly larger and each has its own bathroom.

Student: Oh, having my own bathroom would be great. Cedar Hall sounds more appealing.

Officer: Let me check availability. Cedar Hall has rooms available in both Block A and Block B. Block A faces the library and tends to be quieter. Block B is closer to the sports centre.

Officer: Let me finish the student-housing enquiry by summarising what I have recorded. For this student-housing enquiry, I will repeat the selected arrangement, spell any unusual word, and explain what happens next. The summary closes the student-housing enquiry, so even a minor correction is worth making now.

Student: Good. During the student-housing enquiry, I will listen carefully and make sure no assumption has slipped in.

Student: I'll be studying a lot, so quiet would suit me better. Block A please.

Officer: Perfect. Now, for the application, I'll need a copy of your acceptance letter, your passport, and one recent bank statement.

Student: I have all of those. Can I send them by email?

Student: Before we close the student-housing enquiry, could you tell me how I should raise a question after today? I would prefer not to repeat the whole enquiry if one detail changes.

Officer: Certainly. Keep the reference on the confirmation and quote it when you contact us. A colleague can then see the agreed record, identify the single point that needs attention and explain whether the change affects anything else.

Officer: Yes. Send them to housing@greenfield.ac.uk. Once we receive your documents, we'll confirm your room within three working days and send you a contract to sign.

Student: And is there a deposit?

Officer: Yes. The deposit is equivalent to one month's rent. It's fully refundable at the end of your stay provided the room is left in good condition.

## 02 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 2: Audioguía del museo de historia natural

Welcome to the National Natural History Museum. This audio guide will introduce you to our main galleries and help you make the most of your visit. Before describing the individual features of this natural-history museum visit, it is useful to understand the overall sequence. The information for the natural-history museum visit follows the order in which most people encounter the site or activity, moving from the arrival point to the places that need closer explanation. Knowing that sequence will make the later directions and choices in the natural-history museum visit easier to follow. You are currently in the Grand Hall, our main entrance. From here, you can access all four of our permanent galleries.

Please note that the café on your left is open until six o'clock, and the gift shop on your right closes at five-thirty. Some arrangements connected with the natural-history museum visit may have changed since older information was prepared. During the natural-history museum visit, listen for the difference between a permanent feature and something available only at a stated time. Where a condition in the natural-history museum visit is fixed, it will be presented as a rule; where there is flexibility, it will be described as a recommendation. Gallery One is dedicated to Earth's geological history, covering the formation of continents, volcanic activity, and earthquakes. This gallery is particularly popular with school groups.

You'll find interactive panels where visitors can simulate small earthquakes and examine real rock samples dating back over three billion years. As the natural-history museum visit continues, access and movement need to remain clear for everyone. Within the natural-history museum visit, a change to a minor detail does not necessarily alter the main programme. If an alternative becomes necessary during the natural-history museum visit, wait for the full announcement before moving, because the first place mentioned may be the one that is no longer available. Gallery Two focuses on evolution and biodiversity. The centrepiece is our famous blue whale skeleton, which is 26 metres in length and took two years to reassemble following restoration work.

You'll also find over two thousand specimens of insects, birds, and mammals on display. Many visitors are surprised to learn that less than 10% of the world's known species are preserved here - it gives a sense of how vast the natural world truly is. Do not try to memorise every detail of the natural-history museum visit at once. The route will make more sense once its main stages are connected. For now, concentrate on where the activity begins, which direction or sequence applies, and the point at which you may need to make a choice or ask a member of staff. Gallery Three is our newest addition, opened just last year. It explores the relationship between humans and the environment through the centuries. Highlights include an ancient canoe discovered in a peat bog in Ireland, believed to be around 4,000 years old, and a collection of tools used by early farming communities in the Middle East. A final way to follow the natural-history museum visit is to separate descriptive information from an instruction that requires action. Examples make the layout memorable, but only stated directions determine the route. Keeping those functions separate will prevent an interesting detail from being mistaken for a change to the programme. Gallery Four is currently undergoing partial renovation, but the dinosaur fossil section remains open. Our most prized exhibit is the Tyrannosaurus rex skeleton in the far corner, which was discovered in Montana

in 1987.

If you become uncertain during the natural-history museum visit, pause at the next staffed point rather than following another group without checking. Explain the last location or instruction you clearly remember, and staff can reconnect you with the correct sequence. This is especially important when two activities begin near one another or when a temporary diversion changes only one section of the route. The programme is designed to allow questions, so asking for clarification will not make you miss the main activity. Finally, we offer guided tours at ten-thirty, one o'clock, and three-thirty. All tours are free and last approximately forty-five minutes. Please meet your guide at the information desk in the Grand Hall.

Before the natural-history museum visit moves to its final practical details, remember that similar locations or services may have different conditions. Listen for the full name, the direction attached to it and any time restriction. A descriptive example may help you recognise a place, but only a direct instruction tells you to change route or take action. If a temporary arrangement replaces the normal one, the replacement will be stated after the original is identified. This final distinction connects the earlier overview with the choices that follow and helps prevent a familiar name from being confused with the service currently available.

## 03 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 3: Conversación de investigación - Redes sociales y bienestar

Sofia: Hi, James. Did you finish reading the papers for our project on social media and well-being?

James: Most of them. I thought the Valkenburg study was particularly convincing - it tracked the same group of teenagers over three years rather than just using a one-off questionnaire.

Sofia: That's what made it stand out for me too. A longitudinal design gives you much more reliable data. Did you find the correlation between social media use and anxiety significant?

Sofia: Before we settle on an interpretation for the social-media research project, we should separate what the evidence actually shows from what we expected to find. Our first idea may still help organise the work, but it should not decide how we describe the result.

James: Agreed. For the social-media research project, we can identify which claims are supported and which remain tentative. That will make the argument more credible.

James: It was statistically significant, but the effect size was quite small. I think the media has blown it out of proportion. The relationship is probably more nuanced than "more social media equals worse mental health."

Sofia: I agree. Some studies show positive effects - like for teenagers who feel socially isolated, social media can actually improve their sense of connection and reduce loneliness.

James: We also need to be careful about cause and association in the social-media research project. Two patterns can occur together without one necessarily producing the other, particularly when the sample is small, participants select themselves, or an uncontrolled factor affects both.

Sofia: Yes. We should match the strength of each claim to the method.

James: Right. And active use - posting, commenting, messaging - seems less harmful than passive use, like just scrolling through other people's highlights.

Sofia: That makes sense. Passive use probably fuels social comparison more. For our literature review, should we focus on adolescents specifically or include adults?

Sofia: Another question is whether our categories for the social-media research project are precise enough for somebody else to repeat the procedure. We know what we intended because we designed it, but a reader only has the written definition.

James: For the social-media research project, let us include one clear example and one borderline case. That should reveal any ambiguity before the final version.

James: I think we should focus on adolescents. There's more research on that group, and the developmental stage makes it especially interesting from a psychological perspective.

Sofia: Agreed. What about methodology for our own small study?

James: The order of the social-media research project presentation matters as much as the individual sections. If we give every technical detail before explaining the central question, the audience may lose the thread.

Sofia: For the social-media research project, we can use the assessment criteria as a final checklist rather than relying on whether the draft feels polished.

James: I was thinking we could use a survey - it's practical given our time constraints. But we'd need to control for baseline mental health, pre-existing conditions, and offline social support.

Sofia: What measurement tools would we use for well-being?

Sofia: Our final review of the social-media research project should use the agreed criteria rather than simply whether we like the finished version. We need consistent terminology, evidence for each claim and a conclusion that answers the question without exaggeration.

James: I will turn those points into a checklist. Then we can sign off each requirement before calling the revision complete.

James: The Warwick-Edinburgh scale is commonly used and well-validated. It covers both psychological and social well-being.

Sofia: Perfect. Should we include screen time tracking data from participants' phones?

James: We should keep a note of any decision we change during the final review of the social-media research project, including the reason for it.

Sofia: Agreed. That record will stop us from reopening settled points without new evidence, and it will show which revision corrected a real weakness rather than merely changing the wording.

James: That would be great for objective data rather than just self-reports, which tend to be unreliable - people consistently underestimate how long they spend on their phones.

Sofia: Let's include both then. We'll ask them to share weekly screen time summaries from their phone settings.

## 04 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 4: Conferencia sobre la migración de aves

Good afternoon, everyone. Today I want to talk about one of the most remarkable phenomena in the natural world: bird migration. Each year, roughly half of all bird species on Earth undertake some form of seasonal movement - some travelling only a few hundred kilometres, others crossing entire hemispheres. But how do they do it? And why? To place the bird-migration lecture in perspective, we need to distinguish the familiar modern description from the longer process that produced it. Within the bird-migration lecture, what now appears stable often emerged through small changes whose significance became visible only later. A simple list of events in the bird-migration lecture can hide those alternatives, so the discussion will emphasise why particular changes mattered.

Let's start with the "why." Migration is fundamentally a response to seasonal changes in food availability. During summer in the northern hemisphere, insects, seeds, and fruits are abundant, and the long daylight hours allow birds to forage for long periods. But as winter approaches, food becomes scarce. Rather than staying and struggling, migrating birds travel to regions where conditions are more favourable. Evidence for the bird-migration lecture does not come from a single source. Researchers may compare controlled findings with patterns observed outside the laboratory. Each source answers a different question and carries its own uncertainty. Agreement can increase confidence, while disagreement often reveals an assumption or a measurement problem that deserves closer examination. Now, the "how" is even more fascinating. Birds use multiple navigational systems simultaneously. First and most importantly, many species navigate using Earth's magnetic field. Researchers have discovered that birds have magnetite crystals in their beaks - effectively biological compasses. A 2019 study confirmed that disrupting magnetic fields can disorient migrating birds even in clear conditions. Second, birds use the position of the sun during the day and the stars at night. Young birds seem to have an innate star map - they learn the night sky during their first summer, before they have ever migrated, and use this knowledge later. Scale is especially important when evaluating the bird-migration lecture.

A process observed in one case, one community or one short trial may behave differently across a region or over several generations. In this bird-migration lecture, examples at different scales will therefore be compared. This comparison helps identify which conditions are essential and which are merely helpful. Third, birds rely on familiar landscape features - coastlines, rivers, and mountain ranges - as visual landmarks, particularly during the final stages of a journey. It is also worth noticing the language of certainty used in the bird-migration lecture. Some mechanisms are supported by direct observation, while others remain the best explanation available from indirect evidence. The final account should separate established patterns from reasonable inference.

Keep that distinction in mind as the examples are brought together. Interestingly, many small songbirds migrate at night, when there is less wind turbulence and fewer predators. Larger birds like geese and swans travel during the day, often in V-formations which reduce wind resistance and conserve energy. Climate change is now affecting migration. Many species are shifting their migration timing - arriving earlier in spring as temperatures rise. This sounds positive, but it can cause a mismatch: birds may arrive before their food sources - the insects they feed on - have become available. This is called a phenological mismatch, and it is emerging as one of the key

threats to migratory bird populations worldwide.

The separate examples in the bird-migration lecture can finally be organised around three questions: what conditions begin a change, which mechanisms sustain it, and what consequences appear later. For the bird-migration lecture, that structure keeps chronology from becoming a list of disconnected facts. The conclusion to the bird-migration lecture will use that framework to connect the details without extending them beyond the available evidence. Conservation efforts are focusing on protecting key stopover sites - the staging areas where birds rest and refuel mid-journey. Losing even one critical stopover site can have devastating effects on an entire species' population. A useful final check is to ask what observation would make the present account of the bird-migration lecture less convincing.

Identifying such evidence keeps the explanation testable and reveals where future research would be most informative. It also prevents a plausible narrative from being treated as complete merely because its separate examples fit together. Thank you. We'll now move on to look at specific case studies.